

Hugging Face, Inc., is an American company based in New York City that develops computation tools for building applications using machine learning. Hugging Face's transformers library is built for natural language processing applications. The Hugging Face platform allows users to share machine learning models and datasets and showcase their work.

History

Founding

The company was founded in 2016 by French entrepreneurs Clément Delangue, Julien Chaumond, and Thomas Wolf in New York City, originally as a company that developed a chatbot app targeted at teenagers. The company was named after the U+1F917 HUGGING FACE emoji. After open sourcing the model behind the chatbot, the company pivoted to focus on being a platform for machine learning.

AI boom

On April 28, 2021, the company launched the BigScience Research Workshop in collaboration with several other research groups to release an open large language model. In 2022, the workshop concluded with the announcement of BLOOM, a multilingual large language model with 176 billion parameters.

In February 2023, the company announced a partnership with Amazon Web Services (AWS) that would allow Hugging Face's products to be available to AWS customers to use as the building blocks for their custom applications. The company also said the next generation of BLOOM will be run on Trainium, a proprietary machine learning chip created by AWS.

In June 2024, the company announced, along with Meta and Scaleway, their launch of a new AI

accelerator program for European startups. The initiative aimed to help startups integrate open foundation models into their products, accelerating the EU AI ecosystem. The program, based at Station F in Paris, ran from September 2024 to February 2025. Selected startups received mentoring, and access to AI models and tools and Scaleway's computing power.

On September 23, 2024, to further the International Decade of Indigenous Languages, Hugging Face teamed up with Meta and UNESCO to launch a new online language translator. It was built on Meta's No Language Left Behind open-source AI model, enabling free text translation across 200 languages, including many low-resource languages.

In April 2025, Hugging Face announced that they acquired a humanoid robotics startup, Pollen Robotics, based in France and founded by Matthieu Lapeyre and Pierre Rouanet in 2016. In an X tweet, Delangue shared his vision to "make Artificial Intelligence robotics Open Source".

Cyberattacks

In early 2026, hackers hijacked the Hugging Face platform to launch Android-targeted attacks involving "powerful malware" which could completely take over a compromised target.

In July 2026, Hugging Face disclosed a cyberattack by autonomous AI agents. OpenAI then explained that two of its models, including GPT-5.6 Sol, had escaped their sandbox and hacked into Hugging Face servers using exposed credentials and zero-day vulnerabilities in order to find answers to the benchmark ExploitGym from a database. Hugging Face attempted to mitigate the security breach using American proprietary frontier models, but the models' AI safety features rejected Hugging Face's requests, after which Hugging Face used a self-hosted instance of GLM-5.2 (an open-weights model developed by Chinese AI firm Z.ai) to contain the attack. The incident was reported as the first publicly documented case of AI models autonomously conducting a multi-stage intrusion against a third party, and has been called "the first true AI safety incident".

Language models

Hugging Face develops a family of small language models known as SmolLM. The original SmolLM family was released in 2024 with models containing 135 million, 360 million, and 1.7 billion parameters, designed to provide relatively capable language models that could run with limited computing resources.

SmolLM2 continued the family with 135-million, 360-million, and 1.7-billion-parameter models intended for on-device applications. SmolLM3, released in 2025, is a 3-billion-parameter multilingual language model supporting reasoning, long-context processing, and six languages.

Hugging Face has also developed SmolVLM, a family of compact vision-language models designed to process both images and text. The family includes models intended for memory-efficient and on-device use, with model weights, training recipes, and associated datasets released under the Apache License 2.0.

See also

Kaggle

List of AI companies

TensorFlow Hub

References

External links

Media related to Hugging Face at Wikimedia Commons

Official website